WITS AHEAD RESEARCH GROUP

The AHEAD Fortnightly

Ushicilelo 2 · 15 Okthobha 2026 · Wits School of Education, University of the Witwatersrand

Kwezi veki zimbini, umbuzo utshintshile ukususka ekubeni iiyunivesithi kufuneka zamkele i-AI na ukuya ekubeni zenza njani izigqibo. UMphathiswa uButi Manamela uxelele inkomfa ye-Universities South Africa ukuba lixesha lokusuka engxoxweni siye kwizigqibo malunga nokufundisa nophando, kwaye izazinzulu zekhompyutha ezimbini zase-Wits, ezivela kwi-RAIL Lab, zithe i-Afrika mayizibekele eyayo i-ajenda yophando lwe-AI endaweni yokusebenzisa nje izixhobo ezakhiwe kwenye indawo. Ngelo xesha linye, iiyunivesithi zaphesheya zirhoxa kwizixhobo zokubona i-AI nakwimiqathango emitsha yelayisensi ecetywayo yi-Turnitin, nto leyo esikhumbuza ukuba ukuthembana nengqiqo akunakunikezelwa kwisoftwe. Kuthi e-Wits AHEAD, zezi zigqibo ezakha isakhono somntu, kwaye olu shicilelo lufika kuwe ngeelwimi ezilishumi elinesithathu.

IZINTO EZINTATHU EKUFUNEKA UZAZI

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NEWS · 14 OCTOBER 2026 · GLOBAL

Joining up AI across recruitment, retention and alumni relations can close graduation gaps, if it is governed well

Ebhala kwi-University World News, umlawuli weprojekthi ye-IREX uCameron Mirza uthi iiyunivesithi kufuneka ziphathe ukuqeshwa kwabafundi, ukugcinwa kwabo kunye nobudlelwane nabaphumelele izidanga njengobomi obunye obudityanisiweyo oluxhaswa yi-AI, kunokuba ziinkqubo ezahlukeneyo ezineedatha ezahlukeneyo. Ucaphula inkqubo yekhompyutha yencoko nohlalutyo oluqikelelayo yaseGeorgia State University, ekuthiwa yancitsha i-"summer melt" ngamalunga ne-21 wamaphesenti kwaye yanceda abafundi abamnyama, i-Hispanic, abokuqala kwiintsapho zabo nabobuhlwempu baphumelele ngamanqanaba alinganayo okanye angaphezulu kunabanye abafundi, ngelixa elumkisa ukuba iimodeli eziqeqeshwe ngedatha yangaphambili zinako nazo ukuqinisa ukungalingani ebezifanele ukuzilungisa.

> **Kutheni kubalulekile:** Kuluphawu lwe-Wits AHEAD olumalunga ne-AI nohlalutyo oluqikelelayo lwempumelelo yabafundi, eli nqaku likhumbuza ngokubalulekileyo ukuba izixhobo zesilumkiso kwangethuba nezokugcina abafundi zivala kuphela imisantsa yolingano xa zihambelana nokugadwa ngabantu novavanyo lokukhethwa, ngqo umbuzo wolawulo i-Wits AHEAD eyibuzayo nasiphi na isixhobo sohlalutyo esiyincomayo.

University World News · universityworldnews.com · Funda kumthombo

Mirza, C. (2026, October 14). How AI improves student recruitment, retention, advancement. *University World News*. universityworldnews.com/post.php?story=20261014130619431

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NEWS · 13 OCTOBER 2026 · SOUTH AFRICA

Wits researchers argue Africa must set its own AI research agenda, not just apply others' tools

Iingcali zekhompyutha ezibini kwi-University of the Witwatersrand, uBenjamin Rosman noSteve James, abaphathi abahlanganyeleyo be-Robotics, Autonomous Intelligence and Learning (RAIL) Lab, bathi uMzantsi Afrika kufuneka aqhube uphando lwabo lobukrelekrele bokwenziwa, kunokuba nje asebenzise izixhobo ezenziwe kwenye indawo. Babhekisa kwi-Deep Learning Indaba, ngoku isikolo sasehlobo esikhulu kunazo zonke se-AI ehlabathini, esatsalela abathathi-nxaxheba abayi-1,300 kumhlangano wonyaka ophelileyo eKigali, kwaye kulo nyaka iqhutyelwa inkqubo yayo i-IndabaX kumazwe angama-48 kwelowo angama-54 eAfrika, nakwi-Machine Intelligence and Neural Discovery (MIND) Institute entsha yaseWits, edibanisa iingcali ezimalunga ne-65 kwizifundo zekhompyutha, inzululwazi yobuchopho, isayikholoji nomgaqo-nkqubo.

> **Kutheni kubalulekile:** Kuluphawu lwe-Wits AHEAD olumalunga ne-AI enengqiqo, imigaqo yokuziphatha, ulingano kunye nomgaqo-nkqubo, isilumkiso ngokuchasene noMzantsi Afrika ukuba abe "yindawo yokwenzela abanye abantu isayensi" sithetha ngqo kwinjongo kaWits AHEAD yokwakha isakhono esikhokelwa ngabantu baseAfrika sokumisela imibuzo yophando lwe-AI, kungekhona nje ukusebenzisa izixhobo ze-AI eziyilwe kwenye indawo.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Funda kumthombo

Luckhurst, G. (2026, October 13). Africa has crucial role in advancing study of AI, say professors. *Times Higher Education*. timeshighereducation.com/news/africa-has-crucial-role-advancing-study-ai-say-professors

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NEWS · 9 OCTOBER 2026 · UNITED KINGDOM

More universities end Turnitin contracts as concerns mount

I-Times Higher Education ibika ukuba i-Newcastle University kunye ne-University of Westminster zidibene ne-University of Southampton ekupheliswe ngokwezivumelwano zazo nenkampani yokufumanisa ukukopa i-Turnitin, emva kokuba yacebisa utshintsho kwiilayisensi olwanga lwavumela umsebenzi wabafundi ukuba usetyenziswe ukuqeqesha izixhobo ze-AI. I-Newcastle yachaphazela ngqo lo mgaqo wedatha; i-Westminster yathi isixhobo sokukhangela ukukopa se-Turnitin 'besingasebenzi kakuhle' kumbhalo obhalwe yi-AI, kwaye isixhobo sayo sokufumanisa i-AI sinomngcipheko 'owaziwayo wezimpendulo ezizizo ezingezizo'. I-Southampton yodwa yahlawula i-Turnitin i-£87,621 kunyaka omnye, phakathi kwabafundi abangaphezu kwe-17,000 abaqalayo kunye nabangama-8,000 abaqhubekayo neziqu.

> **Kutheni kubalulekile:** Kwintsika ka-Wits AHEAD malunga ne-AI enembopheleleko, imigaqo yokuziphatha, ulingano kunye nomgaqo-nkqubo, lo mba ubonisa ukuba ii-yunivesithi ziqalisa ukulinganisa ulawulo lwedatha kunye nokuthembeka kwenyani kwezixhobo zokufumanisa i-AI ngokumelene neendleko, kunokuba zithathe isivumelwano sokukhangela ukukopa njengembopheleleko engenakuguqulwa.

Times Higher Education · timeshighereducation.com · Funda kumthombo

Luckhurst, G. (2026, October 9). More universities end Turnitin contracts as concerns mount. *Times Higher Education.* timeshighereducation.com/news/more-universities-end-turnitin-contracts-concerns-mount

UPHANDO NEENGXELO

Prepare students for post-graduation AI judgement challenges

University World News · 9 October 2026 · Pillar 4: Graduate capability and just transitions. Kwintsika ka-Wits AHEAD malunga ne-AI, isakhono sabafundi abaphumelele izidanga, ukuqesheka kunye notshintsho olunobulungisa, olu phononongo lubonisa ukuba umsebenzi wokusebenzisa i-AI ngokuzithemba kodwa ongachanekileyo ungabonakala unyanisekile njengowo uchanekileyo, nto leyo ebonisa ukuba kufuneka ukugweba ngobungqina, kungenjalo kuphela ulwazi lwe-AI, kuba sisakhono abaphumelele izidanga abasidinga ngakumbi phambi kokungena kwimarike yemisebenzi.

Nguyen, P. (2026, October 9). Prepare students for post-graduation AI judgement challenges. *University World News.* universityworldnews.com/post.php?story=20261009115040153

South African minister tells universities to move from AI debate to decisions on teaching and research

South African Government News Agency (SAnews) · 8 October 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. Kuluphawu lwe-Wits AHEAD olumalunga ne-AI evelisayo kwimfundo ephakamileyo, umphathiswa karhulumente obeka icebo elicacileyo, ngokufundisa, ngovavanyo kunye nobuchule bophando, kunokuba abe ngumxholo wengxoxo jikelele, unika iiyunivesithi zoMzantsi Afrika igunya elicacileyo lokuthatha amanyathelo.

South African Government News Agency. (2026, October 8). *Universities challenged to prepare graduates for AI-driven future.* SAnews. sanews.gov.za/node/84823

Study of students in China, Japan and Mongolia finds access to generative AI does not guarantee it is useful for learning

arXiv (working paper) · 4 October 2026 · Pillar 1: Generative AI in higher education. Kuluphawu lwe-Wits AHEAD olumalunga ne-AI evelisayo kwimfundo ephakamileyo, ukufunyaniswa kokuba ulwimi kunye neemeko zetekhnoloji zasekuhlaleni, kungekhona unxibelelwano kuphela, kuxa kutya ukuba i-AI evelisayo inceda ngempela abafundi bafunde, sisilumkiso i-Wits AHEAD esisebenzisa ngokulinganayo kwizixhobo ze-AI ezilawulwa sisiNgesi ezisetyenziswa kumakhampasi amaninzi olwimi oMzantsi Afrika.

Li, M., Xie, Q., Enkhtur, A., Chen, L., & Cheng, F. (2026). From access to realized affordances: University students' generative AI engagement across linguistic and sociotechnical contexts. *arXiv.* arxiv.org/abs/2610.05301

UKUSUKA KWIQELA

12 Sep 2026 **Ithisisi yobugqirha igqityiwe; umfundi uza kuthweswa isidanga ngoDisemba 2026**
Izilungiso ezifunwe ngabavavanyi zamkelwe kuphando malunga nabafundi abaphumelela kakhulu abafunda bekude kwimfundo ephakamileyo eMpuma Afrika.

12 Sep 2026 **Ingxelo yophando ye-Masters igqitywe ngodumo; umfundi uza kuthweswa isidanga ngoDisemba 2026**
Uphononongo lwe-bibliometric lobunkokheli noyilo lomgaqo-nkqubo olusekelwe kwidatha; inyathelo elilandelayo sisindululo se-PhD.

INTO ESIYICEBISAYO UKUBA IFUNDWE

Development as Freedom Amartya Sen, Oxford University Press (1999). Le yi-H ekwi-AHEAD. Qala apha.

With best wishes for the fortnight ahead,

Director: Wits AHEAD

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